as the first Consul. This Consulate was abolished by Napoleon Bonaparte, who later crowned himself as the Emperor of France. The Revolution thus failed, shattering the dreams of the idealists and the hopes of the poor. Yet the republican idea and principles of liberty, equality and fraternity continued to influence generations to come.


Napoleon as Consul

Impact of French Revolution

The French Revolution had many lasting results. It marked the end of the system of absolute monarchy in France. All feudal privileges were abolished and the power of clergy was curbed. The Revolution united the people of different sections and paved the way for the enhanced power of the state. It also led to the growth of feelings of nationalism and the emergence of an assertive middle class.

Revolution upheld the theory of people' sovereignty and laid the foundation for the birth of liberal constitutional governments in Europe. Liberty, equality, and fraternity became the watchwords of freedom loving people all over the world and inspired many later day political movements for the establishment of liberal democracy in Europe and elsewhere.

Recap

I The American War of Independence

- The foundation of European colonies in the wake of discovery of America and Britain's triumph over other European powers in bringing 13 colonies under its direct control are described.
- The burdensome taxation and colonial exploitative policies of England, depriving the colonies of their autonomy and independence are discussed.
- The proclamation of the colonists 'No Taxation without Representation' prompting England to declare war against the colonies is explained.
- The import of tea against the protest of colonies triggered a revolt in Boston leading to the outbreak of American War of Independence.
- The important battles at Lexington, Bunker Hill and York Town between the Colonists and the British forces are highlighted.
- The Continental Congress Meet in 1774 and the adoption of the Declaration of American Rights, as well as the Second Continental Congress giving the command of the army to George Washington are detailed.
- The surrender of Lord Cornwallis who commanded the British forces and the signing of the Treaty of Paris in 1783, that recognized the independence of the United States of America, are elaborated.

II The French Revolution

- The outbreak of French Revolution in the wake of summoning of Estates General by Louis XVI is explored.

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